

Chapter 2 — Sāṅkhya Yoga

సాంఖ్యయోగ : సాంఖ్యయోగము

"The Yoga of Analysis / Knowledge" · 72 verses · The Gītā in miniature

If you only read one chapter of the Gītā, read this one. Many traditions hold that the entire teaching of the Gītā is contained in Chapter 2 — the rest only expands it. Kṛṣṇa begins by answering Arjuna's despair with the most fundamental truth:

"You are not the body. You are the eternal Self (ātman) — never born, never dying."

From that ground He builds the entire path of **Karma-Yoga** — selfless action — and ends by painting the timeless portrait of the **sthita-prajña**, the person of steady wisdom.

Detailed sheets already exist for the most famous passages of this chapter:

- [karmanye vadhikaraste.html](#) — full word-by-word for BG 2.47 & 2.48 (the foundation of Karma-Yoga, *samatvaṁ yoga ucyate*)
- [sthita-prajna.html](#) — full word-by-word for BG 2.54–2.72 (the portrait of the person of steady wisdom, ending in *brahma-nirvāṇa*)

Other essential verses of Chapter 2

BG 2.20 The eternity of the Self — never born, never dying

न जायते म्रियते वा कदाचिन्
नायं भूत्वा भविता वा न भूयः ।
अजो नित्यः शाश्वतोऽयं पुराणो
न हन्यते हन्यमाने शरीरे ॥ २.२० ॥

న జాయతే మ్రియతే వా కదాచిన్
నాయం భూత్వా భవితా వా న భూయః ।
అజో నిత్యః శాశ్వతోఽయం పురాణో
న హన్యతే హన్యమానే శరీరే ॥ ౨.౨౦ ॥

na jāyate mriyate vā kadācin
nāyaṁ bhūtvā bhavitā vā na bhūyaḥ |
ajo nityaḥ śāśvato 'yaṁ purāṇo
na hanyate hanyamāne śarīre ||

"It is not born, nor does it ever die.
Having been, it will never cease to be.
Unborn, eternal, everlasting, ancient —
it is not slain when the body is slain."
Echoed in the *Kaṭha Upaniṣad*. The Self is what the body is *not*.

Word-by-Word — 2.20 (the eternity of the Self)

IAST	ना	जायते	न	जायते	PRONUNCIATION	MEANING
na jāyate	न	जायते	न	जायते	na JAA-ya-te	is not born
mriyate	म्रियते		म्रियते		MRI-ya-te	dies
vā	वा		वा		vaa	or
kadācit	कदाचित्		कदाचित्		ka-DAA-chit	at any time, ever
na ayam	न अयम्		न	अयम्	na A-yam	not this (Self)
bhūtvā	भूत्वा		भूत्वा		bhoo-TVAA	having come into being
bhavitā	भविता		भविता		bha-vi-TAA	will become / will be again

IAST	IAST	IAST	PRONUNCIATION	MEANING
<i>na bhūyāḥ</i>	न भूयः	న భూయః	na BHOO-yah	not again
<i>ajāḥ</i>	अजः	అజః	A-jah	unborn
<i>nityāḥ</i>	नित्यः	నిత్యః	NIT-yah	eternal
<i>śāśvataḥ</i>	शाश्वतः	శాశ్వతః	SHAASH-va-tah	everlasting, perpetual
<i>ayam</i>	अयम्	అయమ్	A-yam	this (one)
<i>purāṇaḥ</i>	पुराणः	పురాణః	pu-RAA-nah	ancient, primordial
<i>na hanyate</i>	न हन्यते	న హన్యతే	na HAN-ya-te	is not slain
<i>hanyamāne</i>	हन्यमाने	హన్యమానే	HAN-ya-MAA-ne	when being slain
<i>śarīre</i>	शरीरे	శరీరే	sha-REE-re	in the body

BG 2.22 The garment simile — the soul changes bodies as one changes clothes

वासंसि जीर्णानि यथा विहाय
नवानि गृह्णाति नरोऽपराणि ।
तथा शरीराणि विहाय जीर्णान्य्
अन्यानि संयाति नवानि देही ॥ २.२२ ॥

వాసాంసి జీర్ణాని యథా విహాయ
నవాని గృహ్ణాతి నరోఽపరాణి |
తథా శరీరాణి విహాయ జీర్ణాన్య
అన్యాని సంయాతి నవాని దేహీ ॥ ౨.౨౨ ॥

*vāsāṁsi jīrṇāni yathā vihāya
navāni grhṇāti naro 'parāṇi |
tathā śarīrāṇi vihāya jīrṇāny
anyāni saṁyāti navāni dehī |*

"Just as a person casts off worn-out clothes
and puts on new ones,
so the embodied Self casts off worn-out bodies
and enters new ones."
One of the most beloved verses in all Indian thought.

BG 2.62–63 The famous chain of downfall — from brooding to ruin

ध्यायतो विषयान्मुंसः सङ्गस्तेषूपजायते ।
सङ्गात्सञ्जायते कामः कामात्क्रोधोऽभिजायते ॥
क्रोधाद्भवति सम्मोहः सम्मोहात्स्मृतिविभ्रमः ।
स्मृतिभ्रंशाद्बुद्धिनाशो बुद्धिनाशात्प्रणश्यति ॥

"Brooding on objects → attachment → desire → anger → delusion →
loss of memory → loss of intellect → ruin."
One of the most-quoted causal cascades in Indian philosophy. Full word-by-word in sthitaprajna.html.

□ Essential take-away of Chapter 2

You are the eternal Self. Act without attachment to results. Be even-minded in success and failure.

If a person could remember just three Sanskrit phrases from the entire Gītā, these three from Chapter 2 would carry the whole teaching:

1. *na jāyate mriyate vā kadācit* (2.20) — The Self is never born and never dies.

2. *karmanṇy evādhikāraḥ te* (2.47) — *Your right is to action alone.*

3. *saṃatvaṃ yoga ucyate* (2.48) — *Equanimity itself is yoga.*

संन्यासयोगः

संन्यासः

IAST

Pronunciation

English